UNIVERSITÉ MARIE & LOUIS PASTEUR

Final Project Report

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Master 2 Neuromarketing and Behavioral Economics

SERENVE

AI-DRIVEN PERSONALIZED SKINCARE

STRATEGY REPORT

by

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1. INTRODUCTION & EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Serenve is an AI-driven personalized skincare brand built around one core belief: Your skin is unique—your skincare should be too. The current skincare market is flooded with generic solutions, causing consumers to experience choice paralysis, anxiety, and wasted money.

Serenve solves this by merging neuromarketing science, behavioral economics, and advanced AI computer vision into a unified experience. Through a proprietary AI facial-scanning website, Serenve analyzes skin health in real-time and prescribes routines that are scientifically accurate, emotionally comforting, and deeply personalized.

This report outlines an end-to-end strategy to own the intersection of technology and wellness, turning the sales process into a trusted, transformative ritual.

2. PHASE 1: UNDERSTANDING THE CONSUMER

2.1 Target Market Profiling

- Persona: The Conscious Glow Seeker.
- Demographics: Ages 22–45; primarily female but inclusive; urban or suburban; middle-to-upper income.
- Psychographics: Values self-care, scientific validation, and transparency; fears product mistakes; wants results without stress.
- Emotional Core: Seeks control over appearance but wants the process to feel like a calming ritual, not a chore.

2.2 The Buyer Journey – The Serenity Loop

The loop is intentionally designed to move from curiosity to long-term commitment, embedding Serenve into daily life.

1. Awareness: Audience sees a brand message like "The skin profile you never knew you had," and curiosity triggers a click-through to the website.
2. Engagement: User arrives and begins the AI scan, which is perceived as medical-grade analysis, creating authority and trust within seconds.
3. Conversion: A personalized bundle appears; because it feels built for the user, the endowment effect raises perceived value and urgency, leading to purchase.
4. Retention: Weekly or monthly scans, progress tracking, and gamified metrics turn skincare from a one-time purchase into an evolving habit.

3.PHASE2 :NEUROMARKETING STRATEGY (THEORY& EXECUTION)

Objective: Bypass skepticism and speak directly to the consumer’s subconscious needs for safety, status, and relief so that every touchpoint feels intuitively trustworthy and emotionally calming.

3.1 Haptic, Visual, and Structural Packaging Strategy

Packaging is the first physical sensory signal of brand quality, even before product use. Serenve uses multiple sensory cues—touch, look, and sound—to prime calm, luxury, and scientific credibility.

- **Soft-Touch Matte Finish:**
  - Theory: Haptic transference; touching soft, matte surfaces instinctively signals comfort and gentleness, and brains often transfer these tactile impressions to the product inside.
  - Strategic Result: Customers perceive formulas as milder, safer, and premium, lowering anxiety for sensitive skin users.
- **Color Palette (Lavender & Soft Blue):**
  - Theory: Color influences physiological and emotional states; research links pale, short-wavelength hues (violet, blue, green) to lower heart rates and relaxation compared to longer wavelengths.
  - Strategic Result: Packaging colors pre-load calm emotions, making the user more receptive to messaging.
- **Weight & Magnetic Closures:**
  - Theory: Perceived value via weight and mechanical satisfaction; heavier caps and magnetic closures deliver a tactile click signaling durability.
  - Strategic Result: Creates a premium, reliable brand image that sustains higher prices and reduces perceived risk.

3.2 Olfactory Branding – The Serenve Scent

- Implementation: A subtle botanical aroma (e.g., chamomile + sandalwood) is infused into the unboxing environment—not necessarily the product—to stay hypoallergenic while engaging smell.
- Theory: Olfactory pathways connect directly to limbic regions like the amygdala and hippocampus, which are responsible for emotion and memory.
- Strategic Result: Over time, the scent becomes a Pavlovian cue where "Serenve = peace," deepening brand affinity.

3.3 Digital Processing Fluency

- Implementation: Generous whitespace, slow-fade transitions, rounded typography, and minimal options per screen.
- Theory: Processing fluency; when visual elements are easier to perceive, the brain judges them as more truthful and safe, whereas cluttered interfaces create distrust.
- Strategic Result: Users feel calm, focused, and more likely to trust scan results.

3.4 Strategic Integration Across Touchpoints

- Unified Sensory Narrative: The same calming colors, soft textures, and subtle scent cues appear across packaging, digital UI, and in-store environments.
- Authority + Empathy Blend: Visual hierarchy combines clinical-looking design with emotional warmth—essential for wellness brands using tech as a USP.

4. THE USP: AI FACIAL SCAN & TECHNICAL WORKFLOW

Objective: Transform the sales experience into a high-trust consultation, making Serenve's core technology the visible heart of the brand.

4.1 Technical Architecture

- Frontend: React.js / Next.js for fast, app-like behavior ensuring smooth, real-time camera access.
- AI Engine: A Convolutional Neural Network trained on a large dermatological image base to detect multi-dimensional skin features.
- Backend: Python with FastAPI to handle image processing and generate structured routine data.
- Rationale: This stack assures speed, minimal lag, and straightforward scaling, which is key for a diagnostic tool that must feel instant.

4.2 The Scan-to-Cart Workflow

1. Face Capture: User grants camera access with UI guiding precise positioning to reduce errors and match lab-like precision.
2. Computer Vision Analysis:
    - Landmark detection identifies facial structure.
    - Segmentation isolates skin from hair/background.
    - Feature extraction quantifies acne, pore density, dehydration lines, redness, and texture.
3. Serenity Score Calculation: Aggregates indicators into a single 0–100 metric for easy understanding without sacrificing depth.
4. Recommendation Algorithm: Filters 50+ ingredients against the user profile to build a minimal, targeted routine using clinical logic.
5. Reveal: Displays a heatmap of problem areas, explanations, and specific solutions to make science tangible.

Strategic Advantage: The workflow shifts the user from passive browsing to active discovery, making the AI evaluation a differentiating experience.

5. PHASE 3: BEHAVIORAL ECONOMICS & PRICING

Objective: Use cognitive science to nudge decisions toward purchase and value perception without aggressive selling.

5.1 Pricing Strategy: The Goldilocks Structure

Three options are designed to guide choice and set value expectations.

1. Option A: Ultimate Ritual – €49 (Anchor):
    - Acts as an anchor; when users see this highest price first, mid-tier options appear more reasonable.
2. Option B: Serenity Pro Set – €19 (Target Choice):
    - Leverages "extremeness aversion" (decoy framing); the middle option is often selected as the safe, balanced choice. Positioned as the best value.
3. Option C: Calm Essentials – €12 (Entry Tier):
    - Avoids losing price-sensitive users and keeps them in the ecosystem for future upgrades.

5.2 Charm vs. Round Pricing

- Tactics: Serenve uses round numbers (e.g., €49 instead of €49.99).
- Rationale: Round pricing is processed more fluently and carries a premium, emotional tone, whereas decimal pricing feels transactional.
- Effect: Aligns with the calm, premium brand identity.

5.3 Cognitive Nudges Embedded in Copy and UI

- Endowment Effect: Messaging like "We have reserved this formula for your unique skin profile" adds urgency; when people feel ownership, they value the item more.
- Specific Social Proof: UI elements stating "8,400 users with [Dry/Sensitive] skin improved their Serenity Score" are more persuasive than generic testimonials.

- Controlled Scarcity: Using cues like "Limited batch" avoids ethical pitfalls while prompting action.

6. PHASE 4: LOYALTY & RETENTION PSYCHOLOGY

Objective: Convert a one-time purchase into a durable, identity-based habit.

6.1 The Hook Model

1. Trigger: External reminders (email/push) or internal triggers (skin discomfort, curiosity).
2. Action: User logs in to complete a re-scan with minimal steps.
3. Variable Reward: AI reveals a new Serenity Score; unpredictable improvement magnitude releases dopamine.
4. Investment: Users save scan history, building a repository of personal data. The "sunk cost effect" means users are less likely to switch brands after investing time/data.

6.2 Serenve Circle (Identity & Status)

- Tiers: Starter → Balancer → Serenity Elite.
- Mechanics: Users identify with status levels, and consistency bias pushes them to act congruently by continuing to scan and buy.

6.3 Why Re-Scans Matter

- Continuous Personalization: Recommendations adjust as skin changes.
- Data Richness: Improves AI model performance, making future recommendations even more accurate.

7. PHASE 5: THE NEUROMARKETING LAB (VALIDATION)

Objective: Move beyond what users say into what they actually feel and pay attention to, refining assets based on biometric data.

7.1 Methodology

- Eye-Tracking: Maps gaze paths to check if users notice key elements like the Serenity Score or "Add to Cart" button.

- Facial Coding (FEM) & Physiology: Detects micro-expressions, valence, and arousal peaks to reveal friction or delight.

7.2 Experimental Design

- Stimulus: User performs AI scan and sees results/pricing.
- Hypothesis: High arousal + positive valence at the result reveal correlates with significantly higher purchase likelihood (targeting up to a 90% lift).
- Application: If gaze drifts, redesign layout; if confusion spikes, simplify language.

7.3 KPIs

- Time to Fixation: Faster indicates clarity.

- Cognitive Load: High load (pupil dilation/negative expressions) suggests UI is too complex.
- Emotional Resonance Score: Peak height during key moments indicates a stronger brand experience.

8. CONCLUSION

Serenve is not merely selling skincare—it is selling certainty, calm, and a personalized path to better skin. By anchoring the brand in AI precision, designing for the subconscious with neuromarketing cues, and structuring pricing and loyalty around human behavior, Serenve is positioned to lead the personalized wellness space.